3.2.3 How technology and cultural changes can impact on the work of designers

Socio economic influences

Content	Potential links to maths and science

Students should be aware of, and able to discuss, how socio economic influences have helped to shape product design and manufacture, including:
• post WW1: the Bauhaus and development of furniture for mass production
• WW2: rationing, the development of 'utility' products
• contemporary times:
    • fashion and demand for mass produced furniture
    • decorative design.	

Major developments in technology

Content	Potential links to maths and science
Students should be aware of, and able to discuss, how major developments in technology are shaping product design and manufacture, including: • micro electronics • new materials • new methods of manufacture • advancements in CAD/CAM.	An awareness of scientific advancements/ discoveries and their potential development.

Social, moral and ethical issues

Content	Potential links to maths and science

Students should be aware of, and able to discuss, the responsibilities of designers and manufacturers, including:
• products are made using sustainable materials and ethical production methods
• the development of products that are:
    • culturally acceptable
    • not offensive to people of different race, gender or religious belief
• the development of products that are inclusive
• the design and manufacture of products that could assist with social problems, eg poverty, health and wellbeing, migration and housing
• the impact of Fairtrade on design and consumer demand
• designing products to consider the six Rs of sustainability.	

3.2.3.4 Product life cycle

Content	Potential links to maths and science
Design introduction, evolution, growth, maturity, decline and replacement. Students should be familiar with examples of how designers refine and re-develop products in the lifecycle of specific products.	